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// CONFIDENTIAL
STRATEGY //

OMNIPOTENCE ENGAGEMENT ARCHITECTURE

# Strategic Nexus

Strategic Security Scoping v33.0 Omni-Review

ENTITY

Nexus Board Review

NEXUS SCORE

70%

**70**

NEXUS INDEX

## 1.1 Engagement Coverage Index

This score reflects the breadth of technical validation across core governance pillars.

| PILLAR | STATUS | PRIORITY |
|---|---|---|
| GOV | VALIDATED | Strategic |
| RES | VALIDATED | Strategic |
| INT | VALIDATED | Strategic |
| PRI | GAP | Strategic |
| SOV | VALIDATED | Strategic |
| ID | GAP | Strategic |

# Business Profile & Objectives

PART I.A: BUSINESS CONTEXT

| ENGAGEMENT PARAMETER | CLIENT SPECIFICATION |
|---|---|
| Engagement Description | **DORA-compliant Threat-Led Penetration Testing (TLPT) of core banking systems.** |
| Primary Deliverable | **Formal TLPT Red Team Execution Log and Remediation Plan.** |

# Resourcing & Schedule Summary



## Executive Resourcing & Schedule Summary

The following summarizes the operational timeline and resourcing required to execute the defined Threat-Led Penetration Testing modules in alignment with regulatory mandates.

TOTAL ENGAGEMENT DAYS

**3**

ENGAGEMENT COMPLEXITY

**HIGH**

**Automated TLPT Resourcing Allocation**

| ROLE | HEADCOUNT | PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITY |
|---|---|---|
| **Threat Intel & Red Team Lead** | 1 | Strategic oversight, regulatory coordination, and final QA. |
| **Covert Red Team Operator** | 0 | Technical execution, exploit dev, and assumed breach operations. |

## 1.5 Regulatory Alignment: DORA Bank Resilience

**Narrative:** DORA resilience and TLPT-ready scoping for critical ICT systems, functions, and third-party ICT dependencies.

**REGULATORY BODY** — **Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA) (European Union)**

| ARTICLE/REF | TITLE | REQUIREMENT | SCOPING GUIDANCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Article 24** | General Control Testing | ICT resilience testing programme. | Critical ICT systems. |
| **Article 26** | TLPT | Threat-led penetration testing. | Every 3 years for critical entities. |

**Mandatory Evidence Artifacts:**

Asset Register | Threat Scenarios | TI Plan | Remediation Plan

**IMPLEMENTATION GUIDANCE** — **DORA**

### ICT Asset Criticality Mapping

Under DORA, scoping must start with the ICT Asset Register. Every asset in scope must be mapped to a 'Critical or Important Function' (CIF). If an asset supports a CIF, it is subject to more rigorous testing and reporting requirements.

### Third-Party ICT Risk

DORA requires that testing includes third-party ICT service providers where they support critical or important functions. This scoping pack must include a list of involved third parties and confirmation of their authorization to test.

### Threat Intelligence Requirements

For TLPT (Threat-Led Penetration Testing), the scope must be driven by current, relevant threat intelligence. The scenarios defined in this pack should match the TTPs of actors targeting the financial sector.

## IMPLEMENTATION GUIDANCE

### MITRE

**T1190 - Exploit Public-Facing Application**

Adversaries may attempt to take advantage of a weakness in an Internet-facing computer or program using software, data, or commands in order to cause unintended or unanticipated behavior.

**T1078 - Valid Accounts**

Adversaries may obtain and abuse credentials of existing accounts as a means of gaining Initial Access, Persistence, Privilege Escalation, or Defense Evasion.

**T1566 - Phishing**

Adversaries may send phishing messages to gain access to victim systems. All forms of phishing are electronically delivered social engineering.

**T1059 - Command and Scripting Interpreter**

Adversaries may abuse command and script interpreters to execute commands, scripts, or binaries.

## IMPLEMENTATION GUIDANCE

### OWASP

**A01:2021-Broken Access Control**

Testing must validate that users cannot act outside of their intended permissions. Failures typically lead to unauthorized information disclosure, modification, or destruction of all data.

**A02:2021-Cryptographic Failures**

Testing must verify the protection of sensitive data in transit and at rest. This includes passwords, credit card numbers, health records, personal information, and business secrets.

**A03:2021-Injection**

Testing must validate that user-supplied data is not interpreted as commands or queries (e.g., SQL, NoSQL, OS command, ORM, LDAP, and EL expression or OGNL injection).

**A04:2021-Insecure Design**

Testing must evaluate the architectural design for missing or ineffective control design. Insecure design cannot be fixed by a perfect implementation.

**Control 1: Inventory and Control of Enterprise Assets**

Actively manage (inventory, track, and correct) all enterprise assets connected to the infrastructure physically, virtually, remotely, and those within cloud environments.

**Control 4: Secure Configuration of Enterprise Assets and Software**

Establish and maintain the secure configuration of enterprise assets and software.

**Control 12: Network Infrastructure Management**

Establish, implement, and actively manage network devices, in order to prevent attackers from exploiting vulnerable network services and access points.

# Threat Scenarios & Modeling

PART I.C: THREAT INTELLIGENCE

## Threat Intelligence Profiles

The following threat actors and attack scenarios have been selected to drive the execution methodology.

| THREAT ACTOR | MOTIVATION | TARGET OBJECTIVE | PRIMARY TTPS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **APT29 (Cozy Bear)** | Espionage and data theft | Exfiltrate customer PII from the core banking database | Spearphishing, Living off the Land, Custom Malware |
| **FIN7** | Financial Gain | Compromise SWIFT payment gateways | Supply chain compromise, Ransomware deployment |

## 2.1 Digital Chain of Evidence

Artifacts produced during this engagement follow a cryptographically-verifiable lifecycle.

| LIFECYCLE PHASE | VALIDATION METHOD |
|---|---|
| Acquisition | SHA-256 Verified Capture |
| Processing | Air-Gapped Analysis Environment |
| Destruction | NIST 800-88 Compliant Wipe |

## 2.2 Data Sovereignty & Residency

To adhere to regulatory data protection requirements, the following residency rules apply to all engagement artifacts.

| FRAMEWORK | RESIDENCY MANDATE |
|---|---|
| **DORA** | Must remain strictly within EU boundaries or approved adequate jurisdictions. Cloud storage requires EU-based tenants. |

## 2.3 Regulator Audit & Access Rights

The following audit rights and access privileges are contractually granted to the respective regulatory bodies.

| REGULATOR | ACCESS RIGHTS |
|---|---|
| **DORA** | European Supervisory Authorities (ESAs) must have full and unrestricted access to threat-led penetration testing results. |

# Target Scope & Access Readiness



## Core Target Register

The following assets are explicitly in-scope for this engagement.

| ID | TARGET / GROUP | TYPE | ENVIRONMENT | OWNER |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **TGT-001** | api.nexus-bank.com | API Gateway | Production | Platform Team |
| **TGT-002** | 10.50.0.0/16 | Internal Network Range | Corporate | IT Infrastructure |

## Access & Test Data Readiness

Required access and data prerequisites.

| PREREQUISITE | DESCRIPTION / STATUS |
|---|---|
| **VPN Access** | Client to provide OpenVPN profiles for two consultants. |

# Third-Party ICT Supply Chain Scope



## Third-Party ICT Dependency Register

The following third-party service providers (Cloud, SaaS, MSPs) host or manage in-scope assets and require explicit authorization.

| PROVIDER | SERVICE TYPE | ASSETS HOSTED | AUTHORIZATION STATUS |
|---|---|---|---|
| **AWS** | Cloud Infrastructure | EKS Clusters, RDS Databases | Authorized (AWS Acceptable Use) |
| **Okta** | Identity Provider | Corporate SSO | Pending Notification |

# Technical Scope of Work

**TI-PHASE**

### Targeted Threat Intelligence Gathering

Formally scoped intelligence gathering phase designed to identify threat actors, define attack scenarios, and produce the Threat Intelligence Profile required before Red Team execution.

**Allocated Schedule: 1 Days**

**RT-COVERT**

### Covert Red Team Execution

Intelligence-led, objective-based penetration testing executing the scenarios defined in the TI-PHASE. Includes stealth, evasion, and assumed-breach scenarios against core financial systems.

**Allocated Schedule: 1 Days**

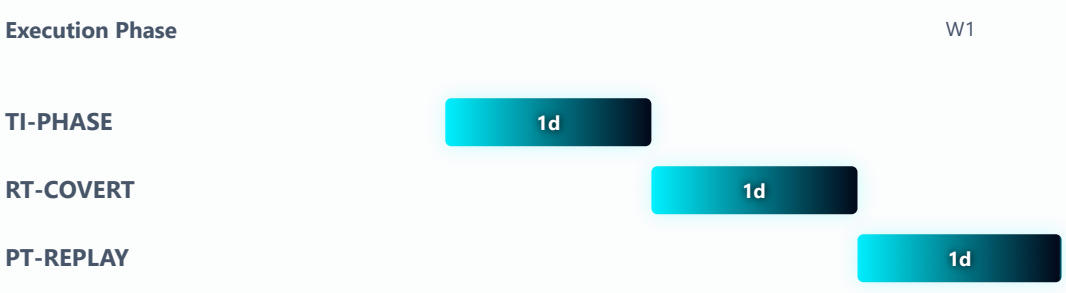
**PT-REPLAY**

### Purple Team Replay Exercises

Collaborative replay of Red Team attack chains alongside the defensive Blue Team to validate SOC detections, incident response capabilities, and SIEM rule effectiveness.

**Allocated Schedule: 1 Days**

## Execution Timeline (Gantt)



# Omni Control Matrix



## 3.1 Omni Control Mapping

The following granular controls are in scope for the selected execution modules.

| CONTROL ID | CONTROL NAME | FRAMEWORK | REFERENCE | IMPACT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **CB_01** | Core Banking Network Segmentation | DORA | Art 24 | Critical |
| **SW_02** | SWIFT Gateway Isolation | CBEST | Objective A | Critical |
| **IAM_03** | Privileged Access Monitoring (PAM) | FRB | SR 13-1 | High |
| **TI_04** | Threat-Led Defense Posture | iCAST | CFI-2 | High |
| **IR_05** | Active Incident Response Capabilities | DORA | Art 26 | Medium |

# RACI Governance



## 3.2 RACI Governance Matrix

Responsibility Assignment Matrix for engagement activities.

| ACTIVITY | THREAT INTEL PROVIDER | RED TEAM LEAD | CLIENT SECURITY OPS | CLIENT EXEC SPONSOR |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Targeted Threat Intelligence Gathering | **I** | **R** | **C** | **A** |
| Regulator & Scope Notification | **I** | **C** | **A** | **R** |
| Covert Red Team Execution | **R** | **C** | **I** | **I** |
| Purple Team Replay Exercises | **R** | **I** | **C** | **A** |
| Regulator Artifact Submission | **C** | **I** | **R** | **A** |

# Regulatory Deliverables Schedule

## Regulatory Deliverables Schedule

The following reports and evidence logs are contractually required to satisfy the loaded regulatory frameworks.

| REGULATORY BODY | MANDATORY DELIVERABLE ARTIFACT |
|---|---|
| **Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA)** | Asset Register |
| **Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA)** | Threat Scenarios |
| **Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA)** | TI Plan |
| **Digital Operational Resilience Act (DORA)** | Remediation Plan |

# Quality Assurance & Peer Review

PART IV.B: QUALITY ASSURANCE

## Formal Quality Assurance Gate

Based on the selected regulatory frameworks and execution modules, the following QA routing is algorithmically enforced.

### REQUIRED QA LEVEL: TLPT Qualified Red Team Reviewer

Mandatory Threat-Led Penetration Testing (TLPT) review gate. Evidence and kill-chain paths must be validated by a certified Red Team peer reviewer before report release.

# Verification & Sign-off

PART V: AUTHORIZATION

NEXUS SEAL

Executive Sponsor Approval

Lead Strategic Provider

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# Engagement Sign-Off

By signing below, the client agrees that this unified scoping document satisfies the engagement coverage requirements for DORA, FRB, HKMA, and PRA compliance regimes.

**Executive Sponsor:** _____

**Date:** _____